



Enhance Firefox

Add some Fire to the Fox! We looked for great Extensions for the Firefox browser, and here are the best we found. We also touch upon plug-ins and Themes

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Firefox, a browser from Mozilla, has been eating into IE's market share for a long time now. The browser has won over a lot of fans around the globe, and India is not an exception. It has an edge over IE in several aspects.

Firefox is a minimal download, and one of its much-touted advantages is that you can easily enhance its functionality by downloading and installing what are known as extensions. The process of installing extensions is straightforward, but not all extensions are safe—you can't completely trust something written by a developer you don't know about, can you?

Here, we attempt to tell you how to build up a wholesome browser for yourself. But before that, we should tell you that it's a good idea to upgrade to the latest version of Firefox—1.5.0.1 at the time of going to print. Some of the extensions listed below need Firefox 1.5 to run.

1 STEP What Are Extensions?

Extensions are browser-specific add-ons. They are generally small in size, and can greatly enhance your browsing experience. What extensions you choose to install is a very subjective thing, which is one of the reason that Mozilla doesn't bundle them with Firefox. Another thing to remember is that many extensions come from third-party sites such as Firefox fan clubs.

Downloading and installing an extension is simple—Firefox has an inbuilt installer for extensions. All you need to do is click on the download link, and the extension organiser does the rest.

2 STEP What Are Plug-ins?

Plug-ins are those add-ons to Firefox that are necessary to run functions embedded in Web sites: say a site has a Flash-based interface. To view it, you will have to add the Flash plug-in. Similarly, you will need the Java, Windows Media

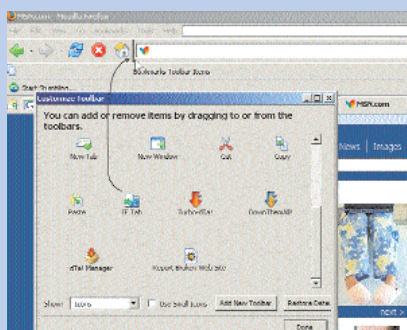
Player, and Acrobat Reader plug-ins, amongst others.

Adding a plug-in means installing the application itself. For example, you will have to install Flash Player from Macromedia, and during the installation, the program will detect the presence of Firefox and bind the player to it.

To download plug-ins for Firefox, go to <https://pfs.mozilla.org/plugins/?application=firefox> and choose the necessary plug-ins for your browser. It is advisable to have Flash player, Acrobat reader and Java.

3 STEP Must-have Extensions:

a) IE Tab
This one is our favorite! It loads Internet Explorer into Firefox tabs. Install IE Tab from <https://addons.mozilla.org/extensions/moreinfo.php?application=firefox&category=Popular&numpg=10&id=1419>



Drag IE Tab button and place it in the toolbar of firefox

Close and restart the browser once the download-and-install process is complete. There are more than one way to use IE Tab. Go to **View > Toolbars > Customise**; a dialog box with a few buttons appears. Drag the button that looks similar IE's "e" symbol and place it on the Toolbar as shown in figure.

Open a tab and click on this button to change the browser's engine to IE. If you want a few selected pages to open in IE automatically, then go to **Tools > IE Tab Options**. In the dialog box that opens, enter the site name as "http://www.website.com", for example, and click Add. Every time you key in this Web site in the

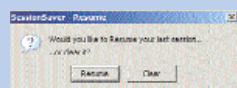
address bar, Firefox will automatically open it in IE Tab. Great for all those pesky IE-only Web sites!

b) SessionSaver

Closing the Firefox window closes the tabs, and they do not re-open the next time you start Firefox. So do you find yourself bookmarking pages only so you can browse to them again the next day? If you do, you need SessionSaver. This extension restores the browser to exactly where you last left it.

Download-n-install the extension from <https://addons.mozilla.org/extensions/moreinfo.php?id=436&application=firefox>

The settings can be altered from **Tools > SessionSaver > Settings**. Choose Expert mode for finer details, and put a checkmark next to 'Every

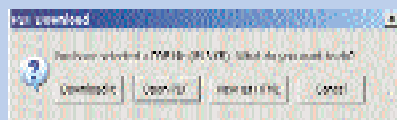


Resume dialog box appears whenever you start Firefox with sessionsaver enabled

startup from', 'Existing windows', 'And tabs', 'When restoring, join multiple windows into one', 'Save a session-backup on shutdown', and 'Allow me to "re-open" closed tabs'.

c) PDF download

Firefox takes time to respond, and sometimes even hangs, when you click on a link that opens a PDF document, especially if it's a large PDF. PDF download opens a dialog box that asks you if you want the link to open in the default PDF viewer, or download it to your hard disk, or view it as HTML. This is a great tool, especially if such options are not available on the Web page itself. To download-n-install PDF download, head to <https://addons.mozilla.org/extension/s/moreinfo.php?id=636&application=firefox>



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